

E outsells paper

Amazon reports that they are selling 105 e-books for every 100 paper books

Tablets galore

Intel: To unveil more than 10 Tablets with partners at Computex - May 2011

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Netbooks have survived the onslaught of compact, frugal notebooks, but a bigger threat looms tablets. For many people, netbooks were a niche that emerged to create a category of user and now that other potential replacements are around the corner, should be allowed to die a gradual death. Netbook manufacturers do not think so, if the models we've received are any indication.

Our take is that netbooks will eventually evolve into something else, as improvements in technology

bring more power to a smaller form factor.

Looks

With all the netbooks lined up together, it isn't very hard to see that the Asus Eee PC 1008P is the best looking of the lot. Also known as the Eee PC Seashell, this one is the designer Karim Rashid special edition. The machine we received for review was glossy hot pink and extremely shiny. The "Digi-wave" design makes the lid stand out, in the midst of otherwise similar looking ones. All ports are concealed.

The Eee PC 1015PW comes with a wave imprint design on the lid. The matte finish makes this less shiny, and makes the netbook feel chunkier than it usually is. Is available in three colours- Purple,

Golden and what Asus calls the "Skin" colour.

The HP Mini and the Samsung NF210 have the understated elegance about them, and multiple colour options to select from. The NF210 also has an elevated curved edge on either side of the keypad. However, we do not like the Acer Aspire One for the fact that it has a very glossy finish. You will be carrying around a fingerprint, dust and scratch magnet. The Champion WBook 10160 is the fattest of the entire bunch, and needless to say, the heaviest too.

Features, build and usability

The 10.1-inch screen limitation is visible across the devices. None of the displays offer the best multimedia viewing expe-



Samsung NF210

rience, and the primary criteria here is to ensure that the eye strain is the least while working on these smallish screens. The displays on the Asus Eee PC 1008P Karim Rashid edition and the Asus Eee PC 1015P are visibly sharper than the others. However, the colour depth is lacking, no matter what the brightness level. The Samsung NF210 offers disappointing viewing on low brightness levels, but does very well once the brightness level is beyond 50percent. The HP Mini's display offers excellent viewing even on brightness levels as low

Survivors or superceded?

While the humble netbook isn't a glamorous device like the tablet, it is silently doing what it is supposed to do- be an affordable computing device, with the motive of portability achieved as well.

